

Mahsa Vian



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Profile

Researcher and educator with a background in Mobility Studies, digital humanities, and social science methods. Experienced in qualitative and digital research, academic mentoring, and curriculum design. My interests include knowledge cultures, digital communities, expertise, legitimacy, and the institutional organization of knowledge.

Education

Master of Fine Art in Mobility Studies- University of Padua | Italy, 2022-2025, [Credentials](#)

Thesis project: **Title:** *From BBS to Blackboard: The Historical Pedagogy of Hacker Culture in Phrack Magazine* (1985–2016)

Supervisor: [Prof. Federico Mazzini](#), University of Padua

- Examined [Phrack magazine](#) as an informal digital knowledge community and early infrastructure of peer learning.
- Analyzed how expertise, credibility, authorship, and community standards were negotiated outside formal institutions.
- Used Critical Discourse Analysis and corpus-assisted digital methods, including Voyant Tools.
- Investigated broader STS questions concerning knowledge production, authority, legitimacy, and informal governance in digital communities.
- Preparing a journal article based on the thesis.

Bachelor of Fine Art in Translation Studies, University of Allame Tabatabaei | 2015-2018

Research Interests

Science and Technology Studies; science and knowledge cultures; digital knowledge infrastructures; academic evaluation; public engagement; research governance; expertise and legitimacy; digital communities; discourse analysis; corpus-assisted methods; digital ethnography.

Selected Research and Coursework Projects

Big Data Organization and Python-Based Text Analysis

- Organized and cleaned textual datasets for digital humanities and social science research.
- Used Python for basic data structuring, categorization, and preparation for analysis.
- Applied corpus-assisted methods to identify recurring themes and patterns.

Data Visualization with ArcGIS

- Created an ArcGIS map of immigration to Italy, categorized by year, purpose, and visa status.
- Used spatial visualization to represent migration and mobility patterns.
- Developed the project as a learning tool for mapping and interpreting social data.

Tourism, Museum Design, and Digital Teaching

- Designed a digital museum concept as a teaching tool for tourism-related learning.
- Used visual and interactive formats to explain historical, cultural, and social concepts.
- Explored how digital exhibitions support public engagement and accessibility.

Digital Tools for Mobility Studies

- Analyzed a photo archive using Zotero, Voyant Tools, and NVivo.
- Used Nvivo, Zotero, Voyant for source organization, tagging, corpus-assisted analysis, and qualitative interpretation.

Gender-Based Injustice in Education

- Authored and presented a conference paper on gender-based injustice in Iranian education.
- Examined how institutions, social norms, and policy structures shape unequal access to learning.
- Connected gender, knowledge access, and institutional inequality in educational contexts.

Teaching Experience

- **Student Thesis Mentor (Academic Support)**
 - University of Padua – Padua, Italy - 2025
- **Pedagogical Manager and English Instructor**
 - Iranmehr Institute & Novin Parsian Academy – Tehran, Iran, 2018 – 2022
- **Online Business English Instructor (Freelance)**
 - Fluentbe (Poland), Twenix (Spain), Busuu (UK) – Remote, 2022 – Present
- **English Instructor and Summer Camp Organizer**
 - Shenker Language Academy – Italy, 2022 – Present

Skills and Languages

- **Research methods:** Critical Discourse Analysis; policy analysis; digital ethnography; corpus-assisted text analysis; qualitative coding; data visualization.
- **Digital tools:** Voyant Tools; Zotero; ArcGIS; HTML/CSS; basic Python.
- **Theoretical areas:** Science and Technology Studies; knowledge cultures; sociology of knowledge; symbolic interactionism; communicative constructivism; digital humanities.
- **Languages:** Persian, native; English, C1/C2 proficiency, TESOL/TEFL certified; Italian, B1; German, A2, currently enrolled in intensive German training in Vienna.